LAUNCH ROADMAP

Brief! - from a closed board to a product

Version 4 | 2.5.0 is live, 2.6.0 is ready | What comes next, and one date that cannot move

Purpose	The steps, in order, that turn Brief! from an invitation-only board into a product a team can sign up for and pay for at briefmessage.net.
What changed since version 3 (October 11)	**M3a and M3b are done** and in production (2.4.0, 2.5.0). **M3b changed shape:** invitation links replaced both the shared code and the bot check. **A Help Center** became its own release (2.6.0). Push notifications and longer sessions are **2.7**. Pricing is public as **free during early access**.
Starting point	Brief! 2.5.0 at https://briefmessage.net: closed board run by AmbroLum, mail through Resend, 332 of 332 tests in the real run. 2.6.0 built, 333 tests. Free Render plans.
How to read it	Prices are those checked for version 3 (October 9 to 11, 2026); confirm them on the vendors' pages before acting. This is not legal, tax or financial advice (Section 7).

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1. Where Things Stand

Area	State on October 21	Status
Joining	Only by an invitation from the owner, by email or by link; one use, 7 days, withdrawable	LIVE
Reading	Members only; visitors see what the board is and how to join	LIVE
Accounts	Email confirmed by link; password reset by mail; deletion by the member	LIVE
Mail	Resend, from hello@briefmessage.net; confirmations and resets seen arriving in Gmail's inbox	LIVE
Terms and Privacy	Published, read and accepted by the author. Not reviewed by a lawyer	DONE
Help Center	Six articles in 2.6.0; awaiting the real run and push	BUILT
Independent review	Done once, for 2.5.0; it found and fixed one serious defect	DONE
Hosting	**Free web service and free database. The database's free period ends November 10**	HIGH
Payments	None. Nothing is charged; the Pricing page says so	LATER

2. The Milestones, Revised

	Milestone	Contents	Done when	Status
M0-M2	**Domain, build, online**	DNSSEC, email forwarding, PostgreSQL and Flyway, Render, HTTPS	October 11	DONE
M3a	**Accounts with email** (2.4.0)	Email on accounts, confirmation, password reset through Resend; closed board	Live October 15; reset tested October 20	DONE
M3b	**Joining, leaving, rules** (2.5.0)	Invitation links, account deletion, Terms and Privacy, the Check your email step	Live October 19; invitation page and link tested October 20-21	DONE
M3c	**Help Center** (2.6.0)	What Brief! is, who it is for, getting started, FAQ, pricing, refunds	Help opens on briefmessage.net after the real run (333)	BUILT
Hosting	**Paid plans**	Web service that does not sleep; database with backups	Before **November 10**	NEXT
M3d	**Reach and stay** (2.7)	Push notifications for mentions, longer sessions, the confirmed-address message	A mention reaches a closed app on a phone	NEXT
Pilot	*One invited team*	*Two weeks on the closed board, on paid plans*	*You know what they used and what they asked for*	NEXT
M4	**Private boards**	A workspace on every post; each board its own owner and invitations; a landing page	Two teams on one server cannot see each other	LATER

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	Milestone	Contents	Done when	Status
Gate	*Validation*	*Five teams, two weeks, free*	*Would two of five pay?*	**LATER**
M4a	**Attachments**	Images, PDF, text on posts; object storage (R2); limits per plan	A file opens only for that board's members	**LATER**
M5	**Payment**	Stripe Checkout, customer portal, webhooks; refund policy with real terms	A real card pays and cancelling downgrades	**LATER**
M6	**Launch**	Uptime monitoring, error alerts, a tested restore, DMCA agent, announcement	Comfortable if a customer signs up while you sleep	**LATER**

What changed, and why

- **The bot check was dropped.** On a closed board nobody can create an account without an invitation, which does the bot check's job better. It returns only if boards ever open to self-sign-up.
- **The shared invitation code was dropped** after the live test of October 15: a newcomer had no way to know it. Invitation links carry it for them.
- **The Help Center is its own release.** It was requested on October 21; keeping one milestone per release, it is 2.6 alone, and the notifications move to 2.7.
- **Paid hosting is now a dated step**, not part of the pilot: the free database expires on November 10 whatever else happens.

3. Before November 10: Paid Plans

> **The one date that cannot move**
>
> Render's free PostgreSQL database expires 30 days after it was created, and is deleted after a grace period. brief-db was created on October 11. Every account and post on briefmessage.net is in it. Upgrading is a few clicks; forgetting is unrecoverable, because the free database has no backups.

Step	Where	Why
1. Upgrade **brief-db** to a paid instance type	Render > brief-db > Settings (instance type)	Removes the expiry; adds point-in-time recovery. Read Render's note on the page about whether the upgrade restarts the database, and do it at a quiet hour
2. Upgrade the web service **brief** to Starter	Render > brief > Settings (instance type)	No more sleeping; start-up was 112 s on the free instance. A full processor should shorten it a lot
3. Check after each step	Render logs; briefmessage.net	"Database: PostgreSQL" in the log, the old posts visible, sign-in works
4. Look at the backups	Render > brief-db > Recovery	Know where the restore button is before you need it

List prices as checked for version 3: web service Starter $7 a month; PostgreSQL basic-256mb $6 a month. Confirm on render.com/pricing before upgrading.

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4. Release 2.6: the Help Center

Article	What it answers
What Brief! is	The 255-character rule and why it works; what a member can do; how it is kept dependable; who runs it
Who Brief! is for	Software teams, small businesses, project groups and clubs; when Brief! is not the right tool; what is available today
Getting started	Invitation, username and password, confirming the address, posting and mentions, signing in safely
Frequently asked questions	Expired links, missing mail, why posting waits, who sees what, phones, deleting an account
Pricing	Free during early access; paid plans announced 30 days ahead; never charged without choosing a plan
Refund policy	Nothing is charged today; terms for paid plans published before the first charge; a mistaken charge is refunded

- **Rule for every article:** describe only what Brief! does today. Planned features are named as planned. Claims a reader cannot check ("the fastest", "the most reliable") are left out.
- **Adding an article later:** one HTML file in frontend-spring/public/help, one line in the list on help/index.html, one name in the test that opens every article. A release each time; an editable Help Center is worth it only if articles start changing weekly.
- **Your steps:** copy the zip over the repository, `.\mvnw.cmd test` (expect 333), commit and push. No Render setting changes.

5. Release 2.7: Mentions That Reach a Closed App

Today a mention shows in the tab title and as a desktop alert while Brief! is open. The idea behind mentions, your own, is to reach a member who is away, in a meeting or at work. That needs push notifications.

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Part	What it does	Notes
Web Push	A member who allows it gets a system notification when mentioned, even with Brief! closed	Standard Web Push through the service worker Brief! already installs. A key pair (VAPID) kept in Render's environment. Works on Android, desktop browsers, and on iPhone once Brief! is installed to the home screen
Subscriptions	One row per device that said yes; removed when the member signs out there or the browser rejects it	Migration V5. Deleted with the account
Opt-in	Asked only after the member's first mention, never at first visit	A refused permission cannot be asked again by the site
Longer sessions	"Stay signed in on this device" lasts longer than today's 12 hours	With a way to sign out every device, which the token generation of 2.4 already provides
Wording fix	An old confirmation link opened by a member already confirmed says "Your address is already confirmed"	From the live test of October 20

One milestone, as usual. If it grows (for example iPhone needs more than expected), longer sessions move to 2.8 rather than delay the notifications.

6. Pricing: Public Stance and Working Model

Public, decided October 21: Brief! is free during early access. No prices are published. Paid plans will be announced at least 30 days before they start, and nothing is charged without the member choosing a plan.

Working model, unchanged from version 3 and not published: a flat price per board, tested at the validation gate.

Plan	Price (hypothesis)	Includes
Free	$0	One board, up to 5 members, the last 90 days of posts
Team	$12 a month per board, or $120 a year	Up to 25 members, full history, mention alerts by push and email, export; files once M4a exists
Larger	On request, later	More members, single sign-on, audit log

- Two paying boards cover the fixed hosting cost of about $13 a month (after Stripe's fees, about $11.27 is left from each $12).
- The refund policy page says today that nothing is charged. Before M5 it gets real terms; Stripe expects a refund and cancellation policy on the site before live payments.
- Nothing here is a forecast of income: it leaves out tax, refunds, disputes and your time.

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7. Legal and Compliance Checklist

I am not a lawyer or a tax adviser. This list prepares the conversation with one; it does not replace it.

Item	State	Next	Status
Terms of use	Published (2.5.0); OneTechly, LLC, New York law, minimum age 13; read and accepted by the author	A lawyer's review before the public launch (M6)	DONE
Privacy notice	Published; names Render, Resend and Cloudflare; says what is kept and how long; corrected after the review	Update when push notifications (2.7) and files (M4a) arrive	DONE
Refund and cancellation policy	Published as "nothing is charged" (2.6.0)	Real terms before M5	PARTLY
Pricing disclosure	Free during early access, 30 days' notice before paid plans	Prices at M5	DONE
Children (COPPA)	Terms state 13 and over; Brief! is a work tool	-	DONE
Email (CAN-SPAM)	Only transactional mail is sent (confirmations, resets, invitations)	A postal address and unsubscribe if marketing mail ever starts	DONE
DMCA designated agent	Not registered	Register OneTechly, LLC with support@briefmessage.net ($6, renewed every 3 years); before M6, and before attachments	OPEN
New York sales tax	Nothing sold yet	Before M5: software accessed online is taxable in New York (TB-ST-128); ask an accountant; Stripe Tax can calculate	LATER
The name "Brief!"	Not searched	USPTO trademark search before paying for a logo or advertising	OPEN

8. Monthly Cost at Each Stage

Item	Now	From November (paid plans)	Growing
Domain (briefmessage.net)	Paid yearly at Cloudflare	same	same
Cloudflare DNS, DNSSEC, email routing	$0	$0	$0
Resend	$0 within the free allowance	$0	A paid plan when the allowance is passed
Render web service	$0 (sleeps)	$7	$25
Render PostgreSQL	$0 (expires Nov 10)	$6	$19
R2 storage (M4a), Stripe (M5)	-	-	Per use

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Item	Now	From November (paid plans)	Growing
Fixed total per month	**$0**	**about $13**	**about $45**

9. Scaling: What Breaks Next

Today	Becomes a problem when	Step	State
Every commit was deployed, tested or not	The first failing commit	Deploy only after CI passes	**DONE** 2.4
Rate limiter scanned every key on each attempt	A flood of new names	Clean up at most once a minute	**DONE** 2.4
Check-then-write on a one-use link	Two requests at the same instant	One conditional UPDATE (invitations, 2.5)	**DONE** 2.5
Confirmation and reset links use the same check-then-write	Two requests with one link at once	The same conditional UPDATE; harm is small (the link's owner only)	2.7
Start-up of about two minutes; sleeping service	Every wake-up and deploy	Paid instance	Nov 10
No backups	The first mistake in production data	Paid database	Nov 10
Every browser asks every 15 seconds	Hundreds online at once	Server-Sent Events	After M4
One board for everyone	The first team that wants privacy	Workspaces	M4

10. This Week

1. **2.6.0:** copy the zip over the repository, delete the old web app files, `.\mvnw.cmd test` (expect 333), commit, push; open Help on briefmessage.net.
2. **Finish the live invitation tests:** sign up through the shared link (it lasts until October 27); invite an address no member uses and sign up through the mail; withdraw one invitation.
3. **Gilberto:** sign in, Send the link again, open it, post once.
4. **Render:** save the deletion of BRIEF_INVITE_CODE; then plan the upgrade of brief-db and brief before November 10 (Section 3).
5. **Send the screenshots** of each step; they become the evidence in OTSR v8.

> **Bottom line**
>
> The product side of M3 is done: invited people join, confirm, read, post, leave, and can read the rules and the help. What stands between Brief! and a pilot team is hosting that does not sleep or expire, and notifications that reach people who are away.

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